

Motwani Jadeja Foundation

Entrepreneurship . Disruption . Innovation

Founder of MJF, Asha Jadeja is an Indian born entrepreneur, investor, thinker and philanthropist based in Palo Alto, California. In her career as a venture capitalist, Asha has invested in over 100 start-ups in Silicon Valley, some of which have gone on to become public companies. Asha founded MITLI to link, synergise, and empower key influencers in business, technology, government and academia to rethink the meaning of development, capitalism and justice for a radically different, planet friendly future.

MITLI Motwani Institute for Thought Leadership in Innovation

Motwani Institute for Thought Leadership in Innovation (MITLI) is a dynamic Silicon Valley think tank and advocacy platform designed to impact government policies in US and India- policies that impact entrepreneurial ecosystems, research and collaborations in exponential technology, and women's leadership in business. With deep roots in Stanford, UC Berkeley, Google and over 200 tech companies in Silicon Valley, MITLI is a first of its kind think tank powered by some of the most influential global thought leaders, academics, heads of state and leaders in technology.

As one of Silicon Valley's most highly respected venture capitalists, Asha Jadeja has invested in over 200 well known technology start-ups in the Valley such as PayPal, Mimosa, AppDynamics, Meraki and Pinterest.

As founding stake holders in Google, Asha and her late husband Prof. Rajeev Motwani of Stanford University played a critical role in establishing the DNA of the company. Not only was Rajeev the author of Google's search algorithms, but he was critical to determining who were the first 100 employees of Google, the start-up. The company now has over 70,000 employees. Asha continues to work closely with Google Ventures, Gradient (Google's AI investment arm) and Google Foundation on various joint investments. Asha founded the Motwani Jadeja Family Foundation in 2012 to make philanthropic investments in promoting entrepreneurship in underserved pockets in Bay Area and India. Her flagship program the RajeevCircle Fellowship now has about 150 Fellows that Asha has worked closely with. The goal in this fellowship is to accelerate the problem solving repertoire of her fellows and helping them "pay it forward". Her fellows collaborate with TED, INK and Acumen Fellows, all of which Asha has supported over the years.

Every year, Asha leads and showcases a group of her Fellows at the World Economic Forum events in Davos Switzerland.

In 2023 Asha launched the Motwani Women Entrepreneurs Fellowship in partnership with TIE Global. This new program will support 40 disruptive women entrepreneurs from India, Middle East and Africa.

Apart from venture & philanthropic investments, Asha has investments in various US think tanks and universities that help strengthen US India partnership on technology, security and trade.

- IIT Kanpur
- Hoover Institute at Stanford
- Aspen Institute
- Milken Institute
- And a network of universities in US, India & Israel.

As a well-known art collector, Asha created India Soft Power Initiative in 2021 along with India Art Fair, University of California at Berkeley and Kochi Art Biennial. The goal of this program is to establish a permanent presence for Indian art at the Venice Art Biennial, the world's oldest and most prestigious art event.



"What makes us human is our hunger for growth. Seeking knowledge and experience is what propels this growth. This knowledge needs to come from self-driven learning and exploration. Failing and learning again. This cannot happen when we have someone telling us all the time - what we need to learn." – Asha Jadeja Motwani

